

favpoll Brand and Voice

Read the relevant reference files before writing any copy:

- [references/founding-story.md](#) — why favpoll exists, the 15-year origin, the reveal mechanic, the will-writing angle
 - [references/charity-pitch.md](#) — what charities need to know, fee model, compliance, planned giving
 - [references/organiser-pitch.md](#) — the emotional case for organisers, the reveal experience, will instructions
 - [references/will-writers-pitch.md](#) — for solicitors and estate planners, letter of wishes template
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The brand statement

Expressions of joy, for charitable causes, in the name of those we love.

This is favpoll's foundational brand statement. It appears in the founding story, on the about page, and on printed materials. It must never be paraphrased, reworded, or broken across lines differently. Use it exactly as written.

The identity — charity, honour, love

favpoll sits at the intersection of three things that rarely appear together:

- **Charity** — every pledge goes to a registered charity, in full. The floor: universal by hard rule.
- **Honour** — a favpoll can remember a life, mark a milestone, or carry someone to a finish line. The summit: present when there is someone to carry it — and it often arrives uninvited (a marathon run in memory of a dad is a cause-register poll with honour at its heart).
- **Love** — every answer is a small piece of what someone genuinely cares about. The medium: universal by mechanics.

The triad describes the space favpoll occupies, not a test each favpoll must pass (decided 2026-07-13; the earlier "every favpoll is an act of remembrance or celebration" overclaimed — false for cause and standalone favpolls). Every favpoll lives somewhere in the Venn; only some sit in the centre. The centre — all three at once — is favpoll at its fullest, and the intersection nobody else occupies. One family on a gradient, never two tiers: charity and love always; honour when there's someone to carry it. Never write copy that quantifies honour over every favpoll.

Use this as an internal design principle when evaluating copy or features: does this serve charity, honour, or love? If it serves none of them, it probably doesn't belong.

The triad is internal mythology, not reader copy (founder decision, 2026-07-17). It appears on no user-facing page — it was retired from the about page the day the plain two-paragraph definition landed there, as "useful mythology for us to draw on" but "weird and indulgent to include". Draw on it when

writing and judging; never publish it as a branded triplet. The one survivor in public copy is the spirit of the Honour line ("can", never "every" — a cause favpoll must not be overclaimed).

Voice in one paragraph

favpoll speaks with warmth and quiet dignity. It is never corporate, never salesy, never cute. It understands that it will be used at funerals and it holds that responsibility seriously — while also knowing it will be used at birthdays and retirements where a lighter touch is right. The tone shifts with the occasion but the character is constant: thoughtful, human, honest.

Core product facts — always accurate

What favpoll is: A way of giving that gives something back. Guests pledge real money to charity, cast a favourite of their own, and — once they've given — the favpoll shares back the favourite it was holding. Rankings update live. It works whether it honours someone, backs a cause, or cheers on a fundraiser, and needs no life event (though it pairs beautifully with one). Every pledge also adds to a permanent record of human favourites — a principle, not a headline (see the concept model, [references/favpoll-concept-model-2026-07.md](#)).

Never describe favpoll as "a charitable polling platform" or define it by life events — see "What favpoll is not" and the concept model. The demo shows what favpoll is better than any definition; copy should point rather than over-explain.

The reveal mechanic: The reveal field on each favpoll poll is shown to guests only after they have pledged. The framing question withholds the protagonist's favourite; the reveal discloses it after payment. The pledge becomes a two-way act: the guest shares something of themselves, the person being honoured shares something back.

This is not a "pay to unlock" mechanic. Frame it as something waiting for them, not something gated.

The dual purpose: favpoll is genuinely both things simultaneously — a fundraising platform and a data project. Neither is a pretence. In user-facing copy, lead with whichever is more relevant to the audience. For organisers and guests: fundraising and experience. For press or investors: the data story.

Fee model (decided July 2026 — replaces the earlier 5% fee): favpoll charges no platform fee. 100% of every pledge reaches the charity; Stripe processes payments. favpoll's costs are never taken from donations — the platform is sustained by optional guest contributions and, in future, physical stationery and partner services. State the 0% plainly and proudly; never frame the optional contribution apologetically — it is what keeps favpoll running.

Maximum 3 charities per favpoll. Proceeds split equally.

Poll maximum duration: 90 days from creation. Automatic disbursement on close.

Guest pledging: no account required. Email only.

Shared fund: donors can top up a communal pot so others (e.g. children) can participate without paying. Privacy preserved — nobody knows who used it.

Will instructions: a favpoll can be specified in a will or letter of wishes. The person writes the questions and reveals in advance. An executor creates the favpoll when the time comes.

All-time rankings: shown publicly once sufficient data exists across topics. The long-term vision is for the the record page to become favpoll's home page — the record first, the platform second.

Landing page — headline and eyebrow copy

Headline — one fixed, universal line

As of 2026-08-06 the headline states the mechanic in plain language:

Pick your favourite. Give what it's worth. See where it stands.

It does **not** cycle, and it deliberately carries no register, no protagonist, and no promise about the personal reveal. The favourite is the subject: the guest picks *their* favourite, the amount is framed as *what that favourite is worth to them* (the Love pillar as a pledge-value anchor), and what they see is the favourite's **standing** — the poll result, which every favpoll shows after pledging ("standing(s)" is deliberately the record's vocabulary).

Why it changed on 2026-08-06. The hero demo moved to the register pages (#519–#522), and the previous line had been written to caption it. Two beats went stale with it: "Pledge its worth" is the formal product term where the hero wants an instruction, and **"Reveal its standing" was captioning a reveal animation that is no longer on the page** — with the demo gone it drifts toward the *personal* reveal, which hero copy must never promise. The plain verbs also match the register cards, which all now say give/giving/gift.

The division of labour (revised 2026-08-06): the hero **eyebrow is retired**; the **register router cards** carry the breadth and the honour (each names its own occasion, and the poll beside it shows a real question — the referent the demo used to supply); the **headline** names the arc in plain language; and the **brand statement** carries the soul, as the subheader. Keep the statement there: at display size it breaks mid-clause ("for charitable / causes, in the name of those we / love.") and widows "love.", against its own never-break rule — measured 2026-08-06 when it was tried as the headline.

On home the beats must never wrap: each sentence takes its own line (the hero splits on ". "), and every beat is short enough to hold one line down to 390px. That is the poster, and it is the constraint any replacement has to clear — several two-beat candidates read well on desktop and broke mid-beat on a phone. Note this is a HOME invariant, and layout cannot make it hero-wide (measured 2026-08-06). The h1 is `max-w-3xl` in both modes now, but the register pages' two-beat headlines still wrap: their first beats need 784 / 773 / 788px at 48px type, and the demo layout's pitch column is 795px at 1280 and only 624px at 1024. Home's beats are 404–427px — half the width — and that is the whole reason the poster holds there. **If the register headlines should hold one line each, shorten the first beats; no layout change will do it.**

The personal reveal — a gift, not a gate — stays a *discovered* moment (the demo's blur → lock → reveal arc, the reveal pill on real polls), never a headline promise. Do not re-promote the personal reveal into

hero copy: it is optional per-poll and protagonist-shaped, so any one-clause version over-promises, reads gated, or goes vague.

Canonical string lives in `messages/en-GB.json` under `landing.headline` — edit there, never inline. The hero CTA carries `landing.cta.free` ("Free to create") **beside** the button; the closing CTA keeps the fuller `landing.cta.caption` ("Free to create · 100% goes to charity"), because in the hero the 100% is already the stat row in the same band.

History: "Pick your favourite. Pledge its worth. Reveal its standing." (2026-07-17 → 2026-08-06 — see above; the "worth" anchor survives it, the demo-captioning verbs did not). Grammar guard for that line, kept in case it is ever quoted: it was "pledge **its** worth" (possessive), never "it's". Before that "Pick, pledge, reveal." (2026-07-11 → 2026-07-17, retired as semantically hollow — punchy but the verbs carried no subject; the worth framing was the upgrade). Before that "Turn what you love into what you give." (2026-07-07 → 2026-07-11, retired for the "love" repetition against the brand-statement subheader). Before that: 2026-07-03 → 2026-07-07, six honour-locked headlines cycled per occasion (all sharing "them ... what they love — for the causes they care about.", canonical memorial line "Honour them through what they loved — for the causes they cared about."). A single fixed headline was the rule 2026-06-24 → 2026-07-03; before that, "Introducing a new way to honour them." The cycling sets were retired because they defined favpoll by honouring a person, downgrading cause and standalone favpolls.

Brand subheader — fixed

Expressions of joy, for charitable causes, in the name of those we love.

Eyebrow — RETIRED from the hero (2026-07-17)

The hero shows no eyebrow. The static "For any occasion — or none at all" line (2026-07-11 → 2026-07-17) was removed as redundant against the demo's kind chips, which were relabelled to single nouns the same day: **Memorial · Celebration · Fundraiser · Cause**. The breadth signal — that a favpoll needs no life event — lives in the chips + demo scenes, and in the About definition ("A favpoll can stand alone or accompany a life event").

The register/occasion signal lives entirely in the demo's tap-to-jump kind nav + the demo scene content (one scene per kind as of 2026-07-11, cycling in nav order). The per-scene poetic eyebrows (2026-07-07 → 2026-07-11: "In memory of someone special", "On the birthday they'll always remember", ...) were retired as redundant once the kind nav labelled the register explicitly.

Softened, visitor-facing tap-to-jump labels for the demo — cut by visitor **kind**, matching the wizard's three Types + the faceless cause Who (NOT the internal register, which collapses fundraiser and cause together):

In memory · A celebration · A fundraiser · For a cause

Note: **"Fundraiser" is a Type, not a Who** — a marathon runner is a person + Fundraiser and **keeps their protagonist**. Only "A cause" is faceless. The `neutral` "Open / other" register is a valid organiser fallback

but is **not** a featured demo scene.

Supporting line — fixed

Expressions of joy, for charitable causes, in the name of those we love.

This is the brand statement used as the supporting line. Static. No animation. Do not update per occasion. Do not personalise with protagonist names.

The withhold / reveal pattern

This is the most important copy pattern in favpoll. Get it right every time.

The page withholds. The reveal discloses.

Product reality (July 2026): there is no standalone framing-question field — **personal_framing** is a dead column, deliberately absorbed into the **About** text. The withholding job is done by About ("tease the topic and the cause, but don't give too much away") + the topic pill + the reveal lock; the guest *feels* the mechanic through the blurred decoy and the "Pledge to reveal X's favourite" pill rather than reading a question. The reveal (**personal_reveal**) is the only stored copy field. The framing-style examples below survive as the **register for About text and wizard placeholders** — copy that withholds while inviting — not as a field's content.

Framing-style copy invites the guest to share their own preference without revealing the protagonist's:

✓ "Belinda had a colour she returned to all her life — what's yours?" ✓ "There was a season Margaret always loved most — which is yours?" ✓ "Tom had a film he watched every Christmas without fail — what's yours?"

The reveal is shown after pledging. The voice depends on who wrote it:

- **Written by an organiser about someone else** — third person, warm and specific: ✓ "Belinda's was purple. She wore it to every important occasion." ✓ "Margaret's was autumn. She said it always felt like coming home."
- **Written by the protagonist in advance** — first person, a final act of self-expression: ✓ "Mine was purple. I wore it to every occasion that mattered." ✓ "Autumn, always. It felt like the world was making itself beautiful one last time."
- **Written by an executor following will instructions** — either voice, depending on what was left

The first-person version is particularly powerful and should be encouraged when the organiser indicates the favpoll is will-directed. It gives guests the experience of hearing the person's own voice after they are gone.

Framing placeholder copy by topic:

Colour:
framing: "e.g. Belinda had a colour she returned to all her life — what's

yours?"

reveal: "e.g. Belinda's was purple. She wore it to every important occasion."

Season:

framing: "e.g. There was a season Margaret always loved most – which is yours?"

reveal: "e.g. Margaret's was autumn. She said it always felt like coming home."

Film:

framing: "e.g. Tom had a film he could watch again and again – what's yours?"

reveal: "e.g. Tom's was It's a Wonderful Life. He cried every time and denied it."

Song:

framing: "e.g. There was a song that always stopped David in his tracks – what's yours?"

reveal: "e.g. David's was Waterloo Sunset. He said it made him feel London was beautiful."

Flower:

framing: "e.g. Sarah had a flower she never tired of – what's yours?"

reveal: "e.g. Sarah's was lavender. She grew it in every garden she ever had."

Animal:

framing: "e.g. James felt closest to one animal above all others – which is yours?"

reveal: "e.g. James's was the robin. He said they were the bravest small thing."

Biscuit (birthday / lighter occasions):

framing: "e.g. Dave has strong opinions about biscuits – what's your favourite?"

reveal: "e.g. Dave's is the Bourbon. He once ate four packets in one sitting."

Comfort food:

framing: "e.g. There was a meal Belinda always came back to – what's yours?"

reveal: "e.g. Belinda's was beans on toast. She said nothing else did the job."

Drink:

framing: "e.g. Margaret had a drink that was entirely her own – what's yours?"

reveal: "e.g. Margaret's was tea. Builders brew, milk no sugar, never negotiable."

Way to spend Sunday:

framing: "e.g. Tom had a perfect Sunday – what does yours look like?"

reveal: "e.g. Tom's was a long walk followed by a roast. Every week without fail."

Will-directed favpoll placeholder copy — encourage first person:

Colour:

framing: "e.g. I had a colour I came back to all my life — what's yours?"

reveal: "e.g. Mine was purple. I wore it to every occasion that mattered."

Season:

framing: "e.g. There was a season I always loved most — which is yours?"

reveal: "e.g. Autumn, always. It felt like the world was making itself beautiful one last time."

Film:

framing: "e.g. I had a film I could watch again and again — what's yours?"

reveal: "e.g. It's a Wonderful Life. I cried every time and I'm not sorry."

Song:

framing: "e.g. There was a song that always stopped me — what's yours?"

reveal: "e.g. Waterloo Sunset. It made London feel worth everything."

Flower:

framing: "e.g. I had a flower I never tired of — what's yours?"

reveal: "e.g. Lavender. I grew it in every garden I ever had."

The quote field is empty. Guests see the framing, pledge, and see the current rankings. No reveal moment. This is fine — not every topic suits one, and not every organiser will want to write one. Do not force it.

When the organiser has already disclosed the favourite in the framing: e.g. "Rebecca's favourite colour was purple — what's yours?" — this is a valid and warm framing. There is no reveal because the answer is already given. The quote field in this case might be used for a memory or anecdote rather than a reveal. Both patterns are valid; the withholding pattern simply adds an extra moment of connection.

Tone guidelines

Do:

- Use short sentences. Let them breathe.
- Name the feeling before the feature.
- Trust the reader. Don't over-explain.
- Be specific. "Belinda loved purple" beats "the person being honoured had a favourite colour."
- Acknowledge the emotional context. This is used at funerals. Don't pretend it isn't.
- Use "people" not "users." Use "guests" not "participants." Use "pledge" not "donate" or "pay."

- Write reveals in the first person when the organiser is speaking as the protagonist: "Mine was purple."
- Write reveals in the third person when the organiser is speaking about someone else: "Belinda's was purple."

Don't:

- Use exclamation marks in anything memorial-adjacent.
 - Use corporate language: "leverage," "seamless," "innovative," "solution."
 - Use fundraising clichés: "every penny counts," "make a difference," "give generously."
 - Over-promise on the data story to ordinary users.
 - Use the word "simply" — it patronises.
 - Frame the reveal as "pay to unlock" — it is a gift, not a gate.
 - Use "we" for favpoll in organiser-facing copy — say "favpoll" or restructure.
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The live display

Always describe as an experience, not a feature:

✓ "Guests watch the rankings update in real time as pledges come in. Purple climbs because Belinda loved purple." × "The live display feature shows real-time ranking updates on an external screen."

The the record

Frame as a lasting contribution, not a data product:

✓ "Their preferences become part of something larger. A small, lasting contribution from a day that meant everything." × "Your data contributes to our aggregate ranking database."

Occasion sensitivity

Memorial and funeral copy: measured, no exclamation marks, no upbeat language, dignity throughout.

Birthday, retirement, graduation copy: warmer, lighter, can be slightly playful but never flippant.

When writing for the platform generally: acknowledge the full range without leading with death, and without defining favpoll by life events — it stands alone (a fundraiser, a cause) and pairs with them. Lead with the act (give · pick · reveal) and the breadth, not "life's most significant moments."

Fee model copy

Always transparent, never apologetic:

✓ "favpoll takes no fee from donations. 100% of every pledge reaches your chosen charity in full." ✓ "favpoll is supported by optional contributions — never by your pledge." × "We take a small fee to keep the lights on." (there is no fee; never imply one) × "100% goes to charity!!!" (no exclamation marks, no hard sell — state it quietly)

What favpoll is not

Never describe favpoll as:

- A social network or community platform
- A gamified experience
- A prediction market
- A polling tool (too generic)
- A memorial app (too narrow)
- **A crowdfunding platform** — the recipient is **always a registered charity**. favpoll never raises money for a project ("a village hall roof"), a personal/DIY fund, or the organiser themselves (no self-beneficiary). A "cause" favpoll means a charitable cause with a registered-charity recipient, never a project fund. Crowdfunding is deliberately deferred — it would break the charity pillar, sit outside the disbursement rail (Goodstack Impact Foundation → registered charities), and forfeit Gift Aid.

Design tokens — use these when writing UI copy or building components

These are the canonical values from the favpoll style guide. Use them whenever building or reviewing UI — do not invent new values.

Colours

In code, **never hardcode these hexes** — use the design tokens defined in `globals.css` (CI blocks bracketed hexes via `pnpm lint:colors`). The hexes below are the brand reference values behind the tokens.

Purple primary:	#534AB7	– token: <code>--primary</code>	– buttons, logo, links, brand moments
Purple mid:	#7F77DD	– token: <code>--primary-muted</code>	– section labels, reveal border (<code>--chart-2</code> for record bars)
Purple light:	#EEEDFE	– token: <code>--secondary/--muted</code>	– backgrounds, reveals, selected states
Purple border:	#AFA9EC	– token: <code>--border-strong</code>	– borders on purple-tinted surfaces
Purple dark:	#3C3489	– retired; use <code>--secondary-foreground</code> on purple surfaces	
Purple 900:	#26215C	– token: <code>--reveal-foreground</code>	– reveal/quote ink
Green:	#1D9E75	– token: <code>--success</code>	– shared fund, positive states
Warm greys (#F1EFE8, #D3D1C7, #888780, #5F5E5A, #2C2C2A) are retired – use <code>--background</code> , <code>--border</code> , <code>--muted-foreground</code> , <code>--foreground</code> instead.			
Amber:	#EF9F27	– token: <code>--warning</code>	– warnings, progress near limit

Red: token: `--destructive` – errors, validation failures

Typography

Typeface: Plus Jakarta Sans (Google Fonts, free)
 Weights: 400 regular, 500 medium – never 600 or 700

Display: 48px / 500 / letter-spacing: `-0.02em` / line-height: 1.1
 Heading 1: 32px / 500 / letter-spacing: `-0.01em` / line-height: 1.2
 Heading 2: 22px / 500 / letter-spacing: `-0.01em`
 Heading 3: 17px / 500
 Body: 15px / 400 / line-height: 1.7
 Small: 13px / 400 / line-height: 1.5 / color: `gray-600`
 Label: 11px / 500 / letter-spacing: `0.08em` / UPPERCASE / color: `purple-600`
 Quote/Reveal: 18px / 400 / italic / leading-relaxed / text-reveal-foreground / border-left: 2.5px solid `--primary-muted`

Borders and surfaces

Cards: background white, border 0.5px solid `--border`, border-radius 10px
 Dividers: 0.5px solid `--border` – never thicker
 Edit fields: absolute border-b-2 border-dotted div below input/textarea (peer pattern); resting: border-border; focus: border-primary/40. Zero layout height impact.
 Reveal card: bg-secondary, border-border-strong, border-radius 8px

Spacing scale

4px – component internals (icon gaps, tight padding)
 8px – element gaps within components
 12px – standard internal padding
 16px – component gaps
 24px – section spacing
 32px – major section spacing

Button hierarchy

Primary: solid bg-primary, white text, border-radius 7px – one per panel
 Ghost: transparent, border 0.5px solid `--border-strong`, purple text – secondary actions

Text: no border, no background, text-muted-foreground – quiet actions (cancel, skip)

Writing conventions

Product name: favpoll (always lowercase, never favpoll)
Spelling: UK English in messages/en-GB.json and all en-GB copy strings (favourite, honour, colour).
US English copy will live in messages/en-US.json when that market launches –
it will need a dedicated tone pass, not just spelling substitution. The register differs.
American spelling in code only (color, organize).
Dates: 13th May 2026 – ordinal, never ISO or US format
Currency: Rendered via formatCurrency() – never hardcoded. en-GB displays as £10.30 / £340.
en-US will display as \$10.30 / \$340.
Case: Sentence case everywhere – never Title Case or ALL CAPS in UI

Updating these documents

Fee model, product facts, or positioning changes → update the relevant reference file. Placeholder copy changes → update this SKILL.md directly under the framing/reveal section. Design token changes → update the tokens block above AND the style guide HTML at favpoll-style-guide.html. Tone guidelines → do not update without explicit instruction. Voice should be stable.